

Speaker 1 [00:00:02]

Let me see if we have already started. Before we begin the interview itself, I would like to show you a document, which is our consent form for the authorization of the interview. You have already given me authorization, but I need to record it. So, now that I am recording, I will show you the document quickly and explain a few things about the interview very briefly. Can you see the document? Yes? So, this is the consent form. Here it briefly explains that we are conducting an exploratory study called A Multicultural Investigation into the Conceptualization and Measurement of Quality in Launch. It is written here below that, if you agree to participate, the interview should last about 40 minutes and is voluntary. You can interrupt the interview at any time if you no longer wish to participate. This part is important. Here you give your consent for the audio of the interview to be recorded. And here below it says the following: I agree with how my data will be shared. Basically, you have two options and you can choose. Then you tell me what you think is best or if you consider another option that is not here. The first is that everything will be transcribed except for sensitive information, which you can review during or after the interview. Or transcribed excerpts can be shared as long as you cannot be identified. In both options, your anonymity will be maintained. The only difference is that in the first option, sensitive information will not be transcribed. You can review it after the interview. In the second option, the transcription will be complete. I would like to know which you prefer. You can change this after the interview. If you prefer sensitive information to be removed, as in the first option, you can review it later. Do you have a preference?

Speaker 2 [00:02:33]

The complete transcription.

Speaker 1 [00:02:35]

Alright then. I need your email to send this document to you for your signature. Do you confirm that you give consent for the recording and sharing of the audio? You can mark here the option you prefer about how the data will be shared. You can tell me now or write it on [Social Media], either way.

Speaker 2 [00:03:07]

My email is a bit long.

Speaker 1 [00:03:10]

That's okay, I'll send it to you after the interview.

Speaker 2 [00:03:14]

Should I send the signature with the option marked by email or [Social Media]?

Speaker 1 [00:03:23]

You can sign the document or just mark an X. That's great. I've received it. I'll stop sharing now. Let me see if...

Speaker 2 [00:03:47]

Alright.

Speaker 1 [00:03:53]

I will start the interview itself now. We will have some more basic questions at the beginning.

Speaker 2 [00:04:01]

Let me open it here.

Speaker 1 [00:04:04]

Starting, how old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:04:07]

I am [16-20].

Speaker 1 [00:04:09]

[16-20] years old. How long have you and your partner been together?

Speaker 2 [00:04:14]

[<1 year].

Speaker 1 [00:04:18]

[<1 year]? Do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:04:21]

No.

Speaker 1 [00:04:22]

Who do you live with?

Speaker 2 [00:04:24]

I live with my mother and father.

Speaker 1 [00:04:28]

What is your main source of income and what is your current profession?

Speaker 2 [00:04:32]

[Occupation]. I lost my internship. And I am supported by my father.

Speaker 1 [00:04:42]

So your income comes from your father?

Speaker 2 [00:04:44]

Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:04:48]

I would like to clarify that when talking about your relationship, can I refer to your partner as girlfriend?

Speaker 2 [00:04:59]

Girlfriend.

Speaker 1 [00:05:01]

Can you tell me the love story of you two?

Speaker 2 [00:05:11]

So... I went to a party at a place called [City], which is quite famous here in [Country]. I went with a friend of mine for many years, since high school, as my friends couldn't go that day. He said he would go with friends from college, and I accepted. We got there, and my girlfriend was there. We spent the whole night together, but we didn't hook up at that party. When she left, I told my friend that I was very interested in her, and he immediately messaged her. She replied saying she would love to get to know me better. This was on [Date]. On [Month Day] we went out for the first time, and since then we haven't separated.

Speaker 1 [00:06:25]

I see. How would you compare the quality of your relationship to those of your friends?

Speaker 2 [00:06:39]

Among my friends, most are single, but comparing to those who are in relationships, I feel that my relationship has a lot of respect. We understand our limits and differences. We want to make

it work, unlike other relationships where people are different and don't make an effort to make it work.

Speaker 1 [00:07:43]

I see. So, you would say that the difference is not necessarily a limitation. Would you mind telling me how many romantic partners you have had?

Speaker 2 [00:08:03]

Considering serious hookups as romantic partners, there was only [1-5].

Speaker 1 [00:08:25]

How do you compare the quality of your current relationship to the previous ones? And why?

Speaker 2 [00:08:33]

My past relationship was very troubled, without respect and it made me anxious, which is something I think about a lot now. Because I know, I have always been a very anxious person. And this thing, this current relationship doesn't make me anxious, you know? Because it brings me tranquility, something that my previous relationship didn't bring me. I didn't have this tranquility. I think now I have a peaceful relationship, you know? Before it was something totally troubled and, you know, I received crumbs, you know, and I was content with that.

Speaker 1 [00:09:23]

Would you say that a high-quality relationship is peaceful?

Speaker 2 [00:09:33]

I feel this. I high-quality relationship is precisely that you are well there, you know? You are not thinking about what I am going to say here, what I am going to answer, what she is thinking. No, I am there. Simply, I am feeling good. I think this is a synonym for relationship quality. You are at peace in the place where you are.

Speaker 1 [00:09:53]

Can you give me examples of peaceful and not peaceful moments in your current relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:10:01]

Non-peaceful moments were when we realized our differences regarding the types of fun. I like to go out at night, she doesn't. And when I started dating, I made it very clear that I would not stop doing the things I like to do because my partner does not seem to like them, you know? Of course, we will try to find a balance, you know? I won't go out every weekend, but we will find a balance because I won't stop doing the things I like to do because of my partner. And I think this

was a moment that was not very peaceful, you know? These were difficult conversations. We had many difficult conversations, that I think were good for the relationship to grow. We talk a lot, you know?. It's an example that wasn't very peaceful. When we put our limits on the table, you know, put the cards on the table. We understood our limits. And a peaceful moment, I think also in these conversations when we talk about what we are feeling, what we need to improve in the relationship, what we like in the relationship. I think this is a peaceful moment that we have quite frequently.

Speaker 1 [00:11:37]

Cool. And for you, what is most important in a relationship and why?

Speaker 2 [00:11:49]

Affection is essential. The person must show that they like you, be present and care. If you feel that the person likes you, you know? Showing affection in words, you know, showing affection. We know affection. I think it is the main thing because, from my point of view, in a relationship you have to show that you like the person you are with.

Speaker 1 [00:12:19]

What is love for you?

Speaker 2 [00:12:28]

Love for me is patience. It's a desire to make it work. Because we read a lot about what is passion and what is love, you know? Because passion passes, but love stays, you know? So, it's when we know the flaws of the other person, understand and try to help. It's being there, you know? It's affection, patience, compassion. It's effort. For me, it's that.

Speaker 1 [00:13:05]

How important is love in a relationship for you?

Speaker 2 [00:13:08]

Very. It's everything. Love is what makes a relationship last. And we sometimes don't show this love in a way that the other wants. You know this question of love language, you know? And sometimes we have to understand how the other expresses love, you know? The other likes to show love in a certain way or you show love in a certain way. I think it is very important. It is the basis of the relationship, it is love.

Speaker 1 [00:13:51]

How do you know that your girlfriend loves you? Besides these factors, like showing affection which you mentioned is important to you, are there other ways that you interpret and believe that this is her expression of saying "I love you"?

Speaker 2 [00:14:09]

It's a very funny thing, but it's a way that I know she really likes me. She is a person who likes to bite people, you know? So, when she has this action, I realize, "Wow, she really likes me," you know, because she shows her love in this way.

Speaker 1 [00:14:35]

What are the challenges of conflict you face in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:14:46]

I feel that I am a person who likes to say what I am feeling. Do you know the person I was for a long time? I was that proud person who didn't say what I was feeling. So, for example, if I was upset with someone, I would keep it to myself and stay with the person. And the person had to have a crystal ball to guess what I was feeling. And when I started this relationship, I said no, I won't be like that. I will say what I am feeling. But sometimes I say anything that discomforts me, and my girlfriend is a very sensitive person, you know? So, any difficult conversation, she feels bad. And I think this is one of our biggest conflicts. I am a person who wants to say what bothers me, but there is the other side, which is a very great sensitivity, and sometimes it bothers her. And she keeps something that bothers her to avoid conflict. I am a person who wants to resolve things. So I think this is our biggest conflict we face today.

Speaker 1 [00:17:01]

How often would you say?

Speaker 2 [00:17:11]

What I consider discussions were things that kept perpetuating. I think I've already said this. But there is [1-5] month, [1-5] month and a half we don't have any discussions. So we are calm now, you know? We [1-5 months] know, [6-10] good days we resolve it in five minutes conversations. I don't consider it a divergence, you know? But these big ones that we really get upset about have been a while, I think [1-5] month, [1-5] month and a half. Now we are starting to be more peaceful, understanding each other more.

Speaker 1 [00:17:47]

And you even said that these divergences usually have to do with something you talked about that bothers one or the other. What would these divergences be about? What would be the discomfort? Can you give an example?

Speaker 2 [00:18:06]

As I said, I am very open, I say everything I am feeling and my girlfriend is more reserved, you know? Sometimes when she is upset, she doesn't like to talk about it, and I keep wondering but

I know she is upset because of the way we talk, I know she changed her tone. This issue of being more closed regarding her feelings. And this is a very open issue. We understand, and she keeps something that bothers me a bit, and I think this is one of the reasons for our divergence, you know? A moment like this.

Speaker 1 [00:16:00]

And thinking about all you said, how do you resolve these divergences?

Speaker 2 [00:16:12]

In general. So, I feel that we discuss. No, we don't discuss because we have never come to argue, but we have many unpleasant conversations, you know? We at least think it's important to talk about things that bother us. And sometimes it's something we try to reduce a bit because it wears out, right? So we have a good moment, then a discussion, so to speak. So I think these unpleasant moments we go through, we know we are going through at the moment. It is decreasing a bit compared to the past months when it was very frequent.

Speaker 1 [00:17:47]

Do you believe your relationship is good for you?

Speaker 2 [00:18:06]

Very good. Sometimes I even stop to think because it's very lucky I found a person, you know, to have found a person who really makes a point of being there, being present, giving affection, asking about my day, showing affection. It's something that makes me very happy. It's something I didn't have in the past, not at all. And others too, which I don't consider as a serious relationship, that I didn't have that. So it's the first time I'm having this and I think it's a lot of luck, you know? My destiny was a lot of luck to have found her there. And I think the relationship is good because she is a person who shows a lot. It's something I value a lot.

Speaker 1 [00:21:02]

Can you give me an example of how she shows affection?

Speaker 2 [00:21:09]

She is the type who sends good morning messages every day, good night every night and makes a point of hugging me. She makes a point of showing our relationship. She shows affection through hugs, physical touch, and we are very physically affectionate.

Speaker 1 [00:21:39]

Physical, right? Yes, I understand. Do you believe your relationship has changed anything in you? If yes, how?

Speaker 2 [00:21:50]

Wow, it made me much less proud and taught me to talk, to say what I am feeling. Because a relationship doesn't last if there is no dialogue, in my perception, you know? You need to talk, solve problems, transform.

Speaker 1 [00:22:13]

I understand. Do you believe your girlfriend has changed too during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:22:18]

Yes, because she used to be a much more closed person, you know? And she tells me she feels very comfortable talking to me, even though she is different from me in this aspect, talking more or less. But she has felt this evolution this year.

Speaker 1 [00:22:35]

So, you would say that at the beginning of the relationship she was more closed and that changed over time?

Speaker 2 [00:22:43]

Yes, it changed.

Speaker 1 [00:22:49]

Do you feel secure in the relationship? And, if yes, what makes you feel secure overall?

Speaker 2 [00:22:49]

I feel very, very secure in the relationship because I know she is there, you know, wanting my well-being and does everything to see me well. I feel that, you know?

Speaker 1 [00:23:07]

Can you give me an example of a feeling of security? I don't know if you would say, for example, the issue of showing affection, which for you might be a feeling of security, but if there is any other...

Speaker 2 [00:23:24]

When I am upset, for example, she makes a point of insisting and asking what is happening. Sometimes when we are upset, we want to be alone, but at the same time, we want affection and attention, and I feel that. In those moments when I am upset, she knows how to handle it.

Speaker 1 [00:23:48]

I understand.

Speaker 1 [00:23:51]

Well, up to this part of the interview, I have complemented these questions. I will move on to a part where I will show you a scale and ask you specific questions, and you will respond according to the scale. Can you see it? Yes. So, here is the statement: "My partner really listens to me." And I want you to tell me, on a scale from 1 (not at all true) to 9 (completely true), how much you agree with this statement.

Speaker 2 [00:24:31]

Okay. I give an eight.

Speaker 1 [00:24:38]

Number eight. Down here, the same thing, from 1 (not at all true) to 9 (completely true): "My partner cares about my needs." How much would you say for this statement?

Speaker 2 [00:24:51]

I give an eight as well.

Speaker 1 [00:24:53]

An eight, which is the same as the first one you answered. Can you explain why you gave eight?

Speaker 2 [00:25:03]

Because when I have a problem, I say what I am feeling regarding our relationship. I don't like this or that, and she really listens to me, tries to understand my side, and improves in some aspects. That is very important. I feel that she listens to me in these situations, yes.

Speaker 1 [00:25:27]

And, in the same way, with the statement "My girlfriend cares about my needs." Why would you give an eight as well?

Speaker 2 [00:25:37]

Because sometimes I have a thought or a vision of improvement in the relationship, or some disagreement, or something that I need in the relationship but I feel that is not happening, and I say it, and she understands. And this shows that she cares and tries to understand.

Speaker 1 [00:26:13]

I will get out of this scale now, but I will come back to it quickly. I just wanted to ask you two questions, if you feel comfortable. You can feel free to say if this is a sensitive topic for you. But these two questions have to do with your physical intimacy. So, if you agree to answer, the first one is: have you been having sexual relations lately?

Speaker 2 [00:26:46]

Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:26:57]

And the second question is: how satisfied are you with your sex life? And why do you think that?

Speaker 2 [00:27:04]

I consider myself satisfied because, as I said, we talk a lot about these more intimate issues. We didn't have many experiences before this relationship, so the basis of conversation and getting to know each other better is essential. We talk about what we like or don't, and this makes me feel satisfied. Because even if sometimes we don't know what to do, we are there talking and understanding each other.

Speaker 1 [00:27:51]

Right. And then, back to the scale, here is the question: "How satisfied are you with your relationship?" I wanted you to indicate the best answer for you among these options that appear.

Speaker 2 [00:28:20]

I am completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:28:22]

Completely satisfied. And, within this scale, I wanted you to tell me how you would spread your satisfaction in the relationship within this completely satisfied? What number would you indicate?

Speaker 2 [00:28:38]

I think an eight because, whether we like it or not, there are always some things we need to improve, but within this completely satisfied, I think it encompasses everything. I always see the positive aspects, even because the negatives are also present. Besides these positive aspects, I feel we have things to improve.

Speaker 1 [00:29:10]

I understand, I understand. You have already given me the justification we need. We are finishing the interview. I will stop sharing the screen. I noted down some things we talked about, some terms you brought up, like the importance of respect, affection, patience, conversation, dialogue, listening, tranquility in the relationship, and also the differences. Would you like to add anything else that I didn't ask or detail something?

Speaker 2 [00:29:57]

I think I forgot to mention something. An action that we still have, which many couples lose. From our first date until now, we will be [6-10] months together this week, and we continue with the same level of intensity. We started in a very intense way and were dating within a week. So it was very intense, and we continue with this intensity. Nothing has cooled down. I see this as something really special.

Speaker 1 [00:30:55]

Just out of curiosity, do you think this has to do with the question I asked earlier about the relationships of other friends? Do you see this happening with other friends?

Speaker 2 [00:31:13]

I don't see this happening with other friends. I realize that with other couples, there is a cooling down over time, but with us, we continue with the same intensity.

Speaker 1 [00:31:26]

I see. Cool. [name], I would like to thank you for your participation. Before we finish, I wanted to ask you about the transcription. If you want to change your option, you can change it. If you want to keep it, that's fine.

Speaker 2 [00:31:43]

I want the complete transcription.

Speaker 1 [00:31:45]

Complete transcription. And I would like to ask for your help. Basically, I would like you to indicate two people close to you who know an LGBT couple or a non-monogamous couple for me to contact and interview as well. If you could send me the contact, it can be via [Social Media] or email.

Speaker 2 [00:32:40]

I met a couple that I think they know, an LGBT couple. Then I would send a brother of this guy, of this couple that is not a friend to you.

Speaker 1 [00:32:49]

Yes. It would be easier if you could even mention me so that when I contact them, they don't understand anything. Then you tell them that you participated in the interview and that I will only contact them to ask for a recommendation of an LGBT or non-monogamous couple.

Speaker 2 [00:32:31]

I will take a look and let you know, okay?

Speaker 1 [00:32:36]

Okay. Shortly, I will send you an email with the signature. You sign the document itself and send it back to me. Is that okay?

Speaker 2 [00:33:22]

I sign the document itself and send it back to you by email.

Speaker 1 [00:33:27]

Yes, you can send it back. Okay. Thank you and bye. Thanks for contributing. Glad you liked it.

Speaker 2 [00:33:43]

Goodbye, thanks.